

CASE STUDY · DATA ANALYSIS

DATASET FROZEN · 2026-07-30 · N=1,000

TrustMRR

A Look Inside the Indie Startup Economy

COMPANIES

1,000

DATA COLUMNS

29

LISTED FOR SALE

262 / 1K

TOP MRR

\$3.57_M

TrustMRR

The Stripe-verified revenue database for indie startups

WHAT IT IS

A public database of **indie & bootstrapped startup revenue**, built to end "fake MRR screenshot" culture. Founded by Marc Lou, creator of ShipFast/CodeFast.

HOW IT WORKS

Revenue is pulled directly from payment processors via API — not self-reported. Refreshed **hourly**.

Stripe

LemonSqueezy

Polar

DodoPayments

RevenueCat

EVOLUTION

From a pure MRR directory → **verified revenue database + acquisition marketplace**. Founders list startups for sale with revenue, growth, and deal terms attached.

LIMITATIONS

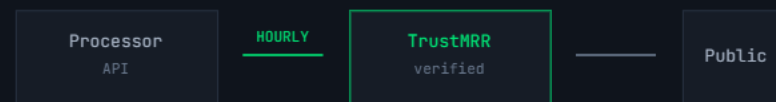
Unsupported processors (Paddle, Chargebee) can't be verified · indie-scale not VC · benchmarking, not diligence

LEADERBOARD SIZE

800+

tracked startups on the leaderboard

VERIFICATION MODEL



Direct API pull eliminates self-reporting bias — the core reason "MRR screenshots" lost credibility.

1,000 companies · 29 columns · frozen 2026-07-30

ROWS

1,000

companies indexed

COLUMNS

29

firmographics · revenue · traffic · deal terms

ANONYMOUS ENTRIES

130

blank · "Stealth" · "Hidden Business"

SNAPSHOT

2026-07-30

point-in-time freeze; hourly API refresh upstream

SCHEMA GROUPS · 29 COLS

Firmographics	name, category, country, audience_type, pricing_model
Revenue	30-day, 3-month, 12-month, all-time totals
MRR & Growth	current MRR, month-over-month growth rate
Traffic	visitors / followers (sparse coverage)
Qualitative	descriptors, tags, positioning
SEO	domain_rating (Ahrefs 0-100)
Sale Terms	for_sale flag, asking price, revenue multiple

DATASET COMPLETENESS · % MISSING

~30% of qualitative fields are blank — treat all category analysis as directional.

pricing_model		34.3%
audience_type		28.8%
domain_rating		28.6%
category		27.4%
country		24.1%

Who's on the platform

AI dominates volume — but volume ≠ quality (see next slide).

COMPANY COUNT BY CATEGORY • TOP 5 • N=726 CATEGORIZED



Note • 27.4% of companies (274/1,000) have no category tag and are excluded.

HEADLINE

Being the **biggest** category doesn't mean being the **best** one.

AI SHARE OF CATEGORIZED

27%

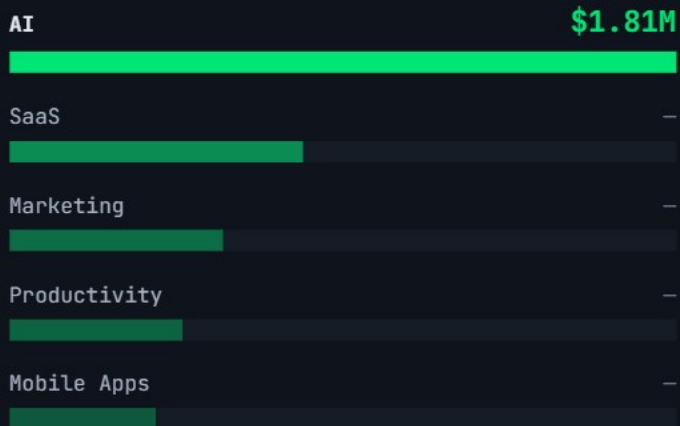
1 in every 4 listed startups is building "an AI thing" — more than the next 4 categories combined.

Who's actually making money

Volume ≠ per-company earnings. Median MRR flips the leaderboard.

CHART 1 • TOTAL MRR BY CATEGORY

AI leads on **sheer volume**

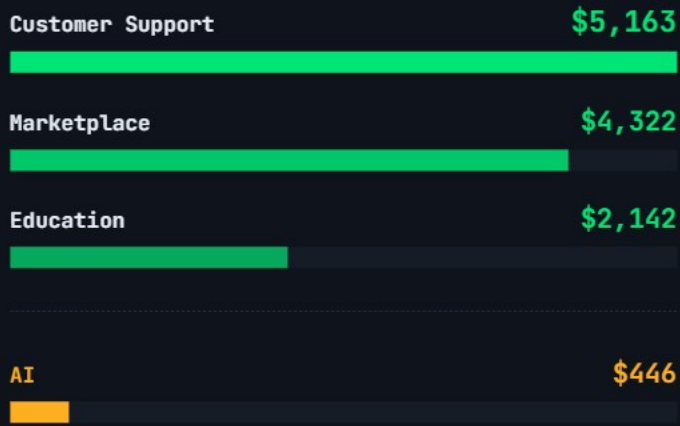


READ

AI's \$1.81M total comes from 197 companies — a wide base, not deep earners.

CHART 2 • MEDIAN MRR BY CATEGORY

The leaderboard **inverts**

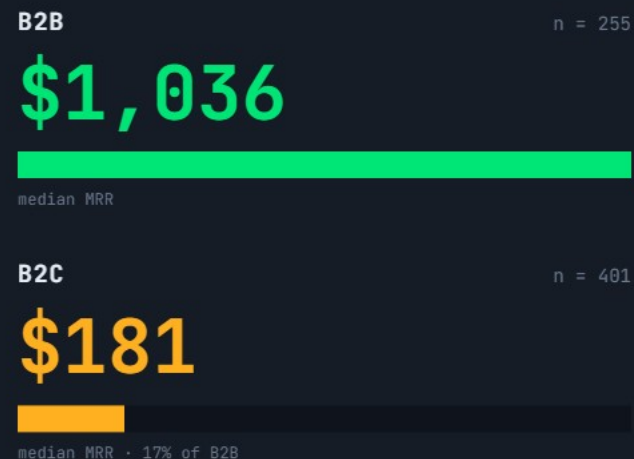


READ

AI's median MRR is **\$446** — a long tail of near-zero earners.

CHART 3 • B2B vs B2C

Audience beats volume

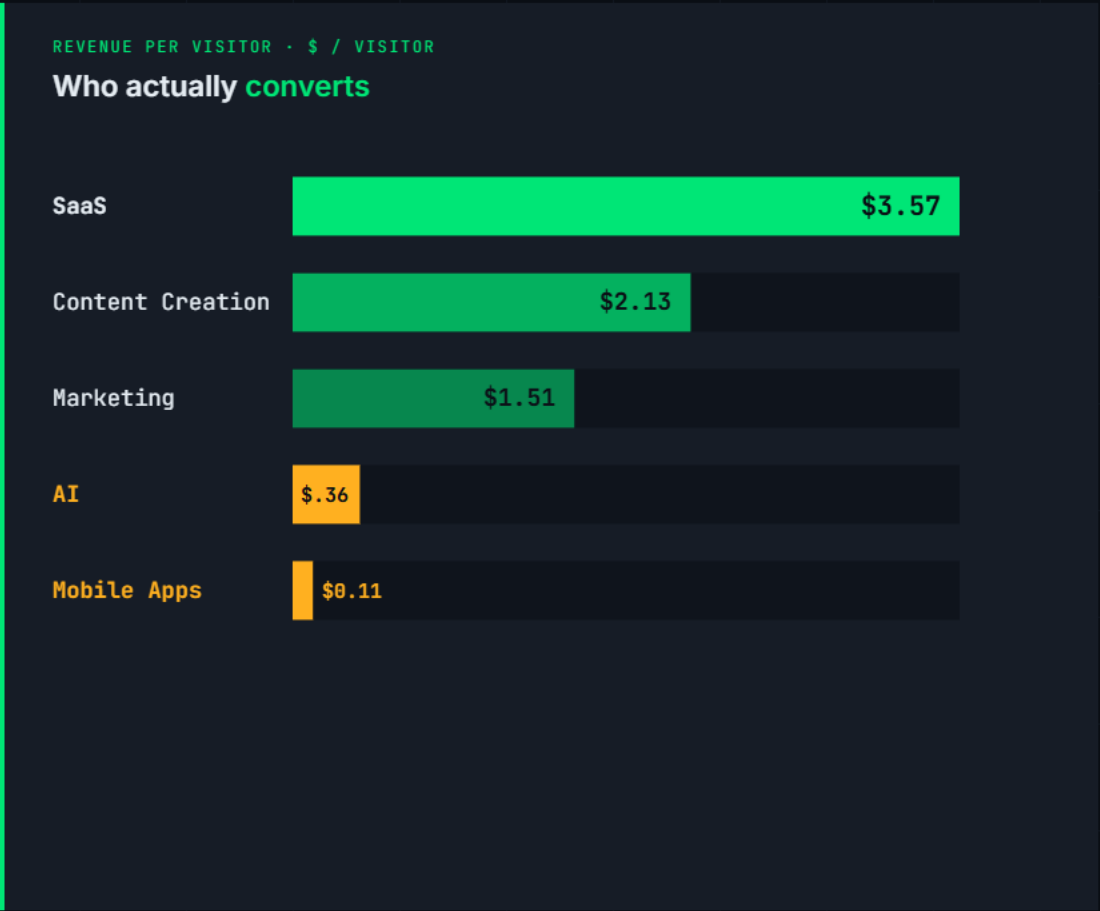
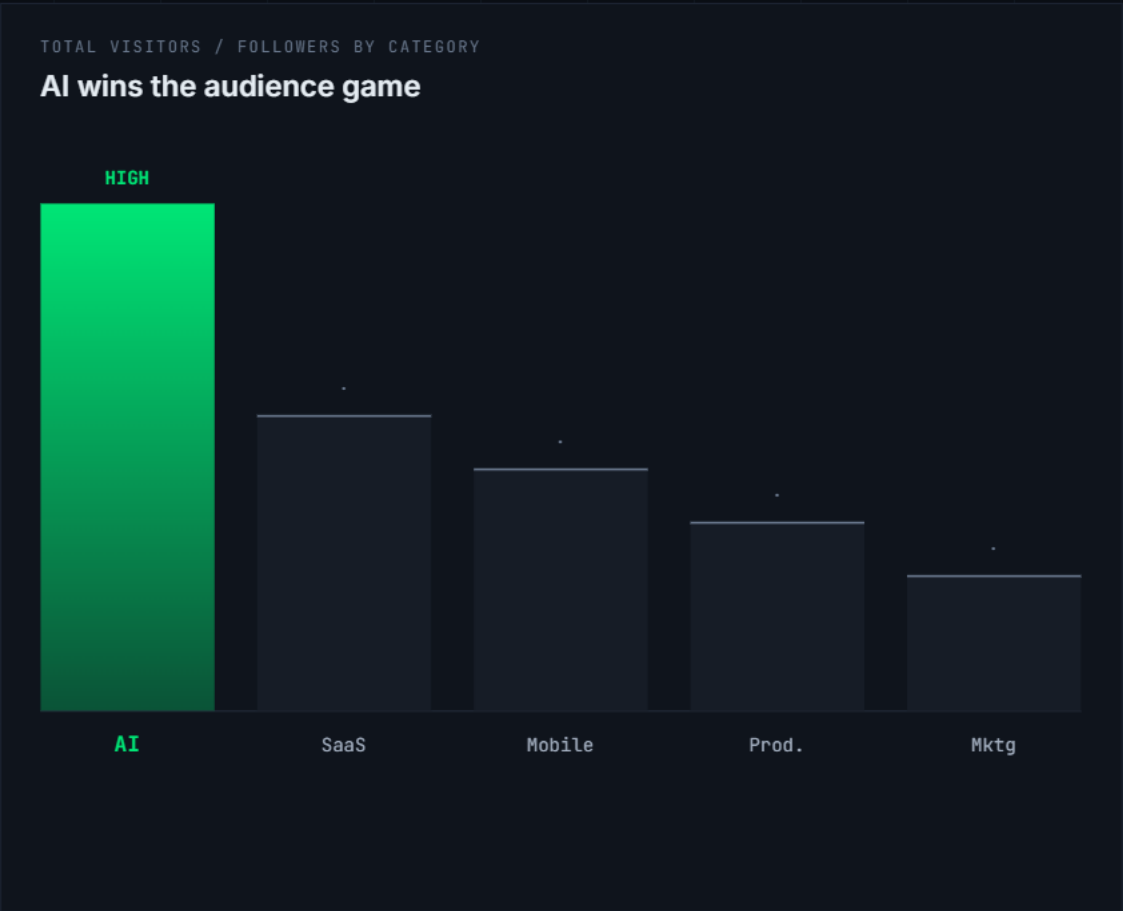


5.7× the median

B2B earns 5.7× B2C — despite B2C having 57% more companies.

Who's getting traffic

Traffic doesn't equal monetization — conversion efficiency does.



HEADLINE · Traffic ≠ monetization. SaaS converts ~32x better per visitor than Mobile Apps.

⚠ Only ~18% of rows have visitor data — directional, not definitive.

SEO authority drives revenue

Median MRR climbs **1,690×** from DR 0 to DR 40+.

MEDIAN MRR BY DOMAIN RATING BUCKET • N=714

A power law, not a slope



log-scaled • median MRR rises ~1,690× across the range

n=714 domain-rated companies

TOP OF DATASET

Stan (stan.store)

DR **89** | MRR **\$3.57M**

The single largest business in the dataset — both by domain authority and by revenue.

▲ THE INVISIBLE MAJORITY

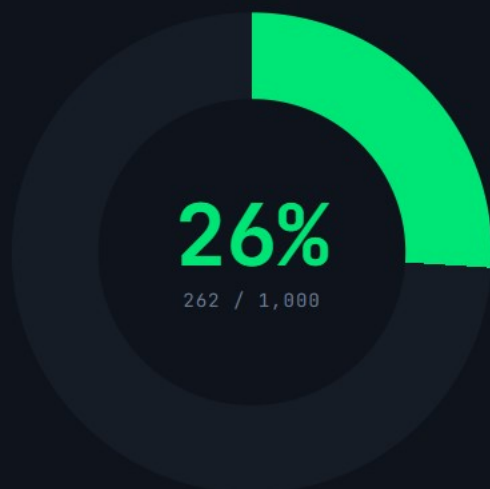
157 / 714

of domain-rated companies have **DR = 0** — essentially no organic search visibility. That's **22%** of the ranked set.

The marketplace layer

26% of listed startups are for sale — priced across four orders of magnitude.

SHARE LISTED FOR SALE



CATEGORY WITH HIGHEST ON-SALE RATE

Mobile Apps

55.8%

More than half of Mobile Apps founders are actively looking to exit — the highest turnover category on the platform.

MEDIAN ASKING PRICE • BY CATEGORY

A 50× gap top to bottom

Content Creation

HIGH

\$250K

— gap —

Productivity

LOW

\$5.5K

B2C • MEDIAN REVENUE MULTIPLE

2.3×

Median revenue multiple for on-sale B2C companies with a stated multiple.

⚠ WIDE VARIANCE

Pre-revenue **"idea" listings** are priced on **potential**, not earnings — pulling the distribution's tail dramatically.

Read the median, discount the extremes.

What the dataset actually says

01 Popularity ≠ quality

Platform volume (AI) and monetization quality (Education, B2B, high-DR companies) are **not the same thing**. The largest category earns the lowest median.

AI MEDIAN MRR

\$446

CUSTOMER SUPPORT

\$5,163

02 Two predictors of real revenue

B2B audience and **strong domain authority** are the two clearest predictors of real revenue in this dataset.

B2B vs B2C MEDIAN

5.7×

DR 0 → DR 40+ MEDIAN

1,690×

03 Traffic without conversion underperforms

High visitor volume looks impressive but delivers weak **revenue-per-visitor**. SaaS converts ~**32×** better than Mobile Apps.

04 Caveat: know what this sample is

A **self-selected, founder-submitted** sample of who chose to be publicly verified — not the startup universe at large. ~30% of qualitative fields are missing.

BOTTOM LINE Verified revenue rewards **B2B focus** + **SEO authority** — not category hype.

TRUSTMRR • N=1,000 • 2026-07-30